A SHORT STORY

by A. U. Thor

Once upon a time, in a distant galaxy called Ööç, there lived a computer named R. J. Drofnats.*

Mr. Drofnats—or "R. J.," as he preferred to be called—was happiest when he was at work typesetting beautiful documents.†

EXERCISE 1.1 Explain why R. J. was happiest at work, and what "beautiful" means for a document set by a computer. Give two reasons, and a third if you can find one.

a) Typesetting is a craft, and craftsmen like their work.
b) The documents were beautiful, which pleased him.

* A computer of the old school, with a front panel of blinking lights.
† Mostly cookbooks.